

## Fighting for a dream

After Rosa Parks was arrested, King led a boycott of the bus system. He organized **mass protests**, which, although they were peaceful, were attacked, and King was arrested and imprisoned. After being released, he led a **huge march** on Washington in 1963, where he delivered a speech, famous for the words: “**I HAVE A DREAM** that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin but by the content of their character.”

In his speech, King called for an end to discrimination.



## A bitter end

King's ideas were very unpopular among many white Americans. His house was **firebombed**, and he was arrested **more than 30 times**. On April 4, 1968, he was shot and **KILLED** by an assassin in Memphis, Tennessee. His death set off riots in more than 100 American cities.



King is buried with his wife near his childhood home.

**King's dream comes true**  
The march on Washington in 1963, and King's stirring speech, made civil rights something that politicians could no longer ignore. In 1964, race discrimination was made illegal. The same year, King became the youngest person to date to receive the Nobel Peace Prize.



**ROSA PARKS** (1913–2005) became a symbol of the civil rights movement after she refused to give up her bus seat.



King was inspired by the peaceful protests, led by **MAHATMA GANDHI** (1869–1948), against British rule of India.